



→ and functionally sound game that will be pretty good. The game will have all the bells and whistles that you would expect from a game coming from a big-name developer, but will almost always compromise the gameplay to suit a novice audience.

Big companies developing big games is not a bad thing, such masterpieces as *Dead Space* and *Modern Warfare* wouldn't have existed if it weren't for such developers and publishers, but these big companies also tend to lose sight of their roots. They would have been innovative at one time— their claim to fame— but the games they produce further down the road might (and usually are) just rehashes of the same formula.

Take this magazine for instance, suppose we decide that mobile phones and tablets are what the majority want and just flood all subsequent issues with content that is built entirely around exactly that content. We will probably acquire quite a new following, but will also alienate the hard-core geek who's here for the Tips n Tricks, PC hardware reviews and maybe even a cover story such as this.

Big corporations spend big money and need to make big money to survive and perhaps they feel that they can't afford to take risks for the sake of a minority (the real gamer). As one hard-core gamer once said, "When financial gain becomes the primary objective, artistic integrity is repressed." You can't blame someone for trying to make a living, but you can blame them for creating a sub-par game.

Again, EA would be the best example here. The direction that they have taken with games like *Dead Space 3*, *NFS Most Wanted* and even *Real Racing 3* echoes these sentiments exactly. The aforementioned games are good games in themselves, but everywhere you can see the hand of a suit interfering with the artist's vision for the game. The company has some of the most brilliant and innovative game designers, who

seem to be plagued by some of the most persistent and pestiferous accountants in the industry. The sad thing is that there must be many gaming companies out there who'd give anything to be just like them. Unfortunately, these large corporations also have a lot of influence and indirectly ruin the gaming industry as a whole— not deliberately and not with any malicious intent, but as a consequence of their motives. This is where the second type of developer comes in.

Developers of the second kind

These developers are the copy-cats. They'll happily clone a seemingly successful game and try to "ride the wave", so to speak. These developers may not intentionally do this, but they might be indirectly influenced by those titles. Anyone who's tried to hunt out an app on the App store or Play store would have encountered this issue; that endless list of *Temple Run* or *Angry Birds* clones.

All this does is dilute the real value of a game and also flood the market with a stream of useless titles. The developers may have made some money on this but the real gamer is hit by the lack of, or inability to find, great games. This is a trend that is very prevalent in mobile games simply because mobile games are easier to create or clone and mobile developers are literally a dime a dozen. These developers might not have a vision of their own, but they may not be all bad either. They might simply be a developer who needs to make



Cat Mario, one of the most wickedly intelligent games ever made

a quick buck so as to pursue a project of their dreams. The only problem is that this process of cloning works. It makes money and there is every chance that the developer in question, despite his best interests, might end up making clone after clone because it's easier.

Developers of the third kind

These developers are the real artists. The people who have a vision that they want to bring to life, people who don't just want to make a game, people who want to create an entirely new experience, maybe just for the sake of their own satisfaction. They aren't trying to make money, they're trying to make a real game for real gamers and any money that they earn is just a consequence of that passion. Any hardships these developers face are just part of the process; they wouldn't consider their troubles a hardship if their goals were to be achieved.

We're not saying that everyone with a vision will make a great game, or even an acceptable game. There are too many factors that are involved and while everyone might want to be one, everyone is not an artist. What really matters is that these people tried, they tried to do something different and even if they fail, they will have left a mark somewhere with, if nothing else, their desire to fulfil their dreams. These are the people that take risks, create tiny companies, desperately try to get funding on kickstarter or, if they're lucky, get hired by a like-minded company. It's from here, these few



Clones do have their uses. As cannon fodder